

Question:

There exist real numbers  $x$  and  $y$ , both greater than 1, such that  $\log_x(y^x)=\log_y(x^{4y})=10$ . Find  $xy$ .

Reasoning + Answer:

Let's solve the problem step by step .

We are given that :

$$\log_x(y^x)=10 \quad \text{and} \quad \log_y(x^{4y})=10$$

Both  $x > 1$  and  $y > 1$ , and we are to find  $xy$  .

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Step 1 : Simplify the first equation

$$\log_x(y^x)=10$$

Use the logarithmic identity :  $\log_b(a^c)=c\log_ba$

$$\log_x(y^x)=x\log_xy=10$$

So :

$$x\log_xy=10 \quad \text{(Equation 1)}$$

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Step 2 : Simplify the second equation

$$\log_y(x^{4y})=10$$

Similarly :

$$\log_y(x^{4y})=4y\log_yx=10$$

So :

$$4y\log_yx=10 \quad \text{(Equation 2)}$$

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Step 3 : Use change of base

We can express both logarithms in terms of natural logarithm , but more importantly , note that :

We know :

$$\log_xy=\frac{1}{\log_yx}$$

Let's define :

$$a=\log_xy$$

and

$$b=\log_yx=\frac{1}{a}$$

From Equation 1 :

$$xa=10 \quad \Rightarrow \quad a=\frac{10}{x} \quad (1)$$

From Equation 2 :

$$4y \cdot b=10 \quad \text{and since } b=\frac{1}{a}, \text{ then }$$
$$4y \cdot \frac{1}{a}=10$$
$$\frac{4y}{a}=10 \quad (2)$$

Now substitute  $a=\frac{10}{x}$  into Equation (2):

$$\frac{4y}{10/x}=10$$
$$4y \cdot \frac{x}{10}=10$$
$$\frac{4xy}{10}=10$$
$$\frac{2xy}{5}=10$$

Multiply both sides by 5 :

$$2xy=50$$

Divide by 2 :

$$xy=25$$

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<answer>25</answer>